- Plastic waste, food materials and vegetables should not be thrown into open drains.
- Proper sewage treatment and management should be implemented.



V. Waterborne Diseases

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Illness caused by the micro-organisms present in the untreated or contaminated water is called waterborne diseases. They are responsible for morbidity and mortality in all age groups particularly among children under 5 years of age. It is believed that 80% of all diseases in the world are caused by inadequate sanitation and polluted water. Poverty, illiteracy, overcrowding and low health services are also directly or indirectly responsible for the prevalence of these diseases.

1 Types of Waterborne Diseases

Diarrhoea, dysentery, typhoid and cholera are some of the common waterborne diseases. They are caused by micro-organisms like bacteria and virus. Some of them are spread by mosquitoes. The following table gives the causative agents and the symptoms of few waterborne diseases.

Name of the Waterborne Diseases	Causative Agents	Symptoms
Diarrhoea	Bacteria and Parasites (Salmonella, Shigella and E.coli)	Indigestion, Sweating, Abdominal pain, Vomiting, Stomach cramps
Dysentery (Shigellosis)	Bacteria (Shigella)	Blood in stool, Indigestion, Vomiting, Dehydration, Fever, Weight loss
Typhoid Fever	Bacteria (Salmonella)	High fever, Head ache, Stomach pain, Muscle weakness, Weight loss
Cholera	Bacteria (Vibrio Cholerae)	Severe diarrhea, Vomiting, Dehydration
Hepatitus –A	Virus (Hepatitus)	Vomiting, Fever, Dark urine, Itching, Yellow skin and eyes, Lack of appetite
Hepatitus - E	Virus (Hepatitus-E)	Vomiting, Fever, Dark urine, Itching, Yellow skin and eyes, Lack of appetite

